

Yaser Hatami

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PROFILE

Urban studies researcher working on planning theory, discourse analysis and spatial governance. Research examines how populist and antagonistic discourses shape urban planning conflicts and legitimise speculative development, using Hamadan (Iran) as the main case. Develops mixed methods that combine post-structuralist discourse theory with topic modelling to analyse thousands of media texts. Also contributes to quantitative studies of housing markets and air quality in Tehran. Collaborates with Dr Nader Zali (University of Guilan) and Dr Nasser Barati (Soore University, Tehran).

EDUCATION

PhD, Urban Planning

Department of Urban Planning

University of Guilan, Iran

RESEARCH INTERESTS

- Planning theory, discourse theory and agonistic planning
- Urban politics, populism and spatial governance
- Speculative urbanism, land-use conflict and territorial expansion
- Media and public discourse on urban development
- Computational text analysis and big data in urban studies
- Housing markets and environmental quality in Iranian cities

METHODS & SKILLS

Discourse analysis	Post-structuralist discourse theory (Laclau & Mouffe), qualitative media analysis of large text corpora
Computational methods	Topic modelling, text mining and big-data analysis of newspaper and media archives
Quantitative analysis	Generalised linear mixed models, spatial clustering, land-use density indicators
Case expertise	Urban development conflicts in Hamadan; housing and air quality in Tehran

PEER-REVIEWED JOURNAL ARTICLES

- [5] 2026 **Hatami, Y.**, Zali, N., & Barati, N. Populist urbanism and the speculation network: Discourse, conflict, and planning monopoly in Hamadan. *Journal of Urban Management*.
- [4] 2026 Roohani Qadikolaei, M., **Hatami, Y.**, Nikmard Namin, S., & Soltani, A. Spatial heterogeneity in housing price-transaction ratios: A historical analysis of Tehran. *International Journal of Housing Markets and Analysis*, 19(2), 426–452. doi:10.1108/IJHMA-08-2024-0118
- [3] 2025 **Hatami, Y.**, Zali, N., & Barati, N. Antagonism of spatial planning and the process of urban counter-development: An empirical study in Hamadan. *Space and Polity*, 29(3), 189–213. doi:10.1080/13562576.2025.2585813
- [2] 2025 Roohani Qadikolaei, M., Soltani, A., Nikmard Namin, S., **Hatami, Y.**, & Najafi, P. Explaining air pollution exceedance days through land use densities. *Environmental and Sustainability Indicators*, 26, 100691.
- [1] 2025 **Hatami, Y.**, Zali, N., & Barati, N. Bridging the gap in urban studies: Combining topic modeling and discourse theory in big data analysis. *International Journal of Urban Sciences*, 30(2), 294–324. doi:10.1080/12265934.2025.2504674

Publication list compiled from the ORCID record [0000-0002-0161-9345](https://orcid.org/0000-0002-0161-9345).